

Hashmat Ullah Sultani

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Hiring Team

CIVICUS: World Alliance for Citizen Participation
Johannesburg, South Africa

Re: Application for CIVICUS Research Internship 2026

Dear Hiring Team,

Growing up in Afghanistan — a country where civic space has faced severe restrictions — I developed a deep personal understanding of why organizations like CIVICUS matter. The ability to measure, document, and advocate for civic freedoms is not abstract to me; it is urgent. It is this conviction, combined with my technical background in data analysis and research, that drives my application for the **CIVICUS Research Internship 2026**.

I am currently in my third year of a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science at Kandahar University, where I have built expertise in data analysis, statistical research, and research methodology. My academic work has consistently focused on using data to understand social realities. In an independent research project, I conducted a statistical study on the relationship between social media usage and mental health balance — collecting, analyzing, and interpreting behavioral data to produce structured findings. This experience sharpened my ability to design research questions, apply quantitative methods, and communicate insights clearly.

I have also participated in a collaborative team project investigating the impact of digital transformation on businesses, where I contributed to literature reviews and primary data collection through questionnaire design. This gave me hands-on experience with the full research cycle — from framing questions to analyzing results — which I believe translates directly to the kind of evidence-based research CIVICUS conducts.

What draws me specifically to CIVICUS is your **CIVICUS Monitor** and the **State of Civil Society** reports — tools that turn on-the-ground realities into globally recognized evidence for advocacy. I want to contribute to that process: helping gather, structure, and analyze data that empowers civil society actors worldwide. My interdisciplinary background allows me to bring both technical rigor and a genuine understanding of the human stakes behind the numbers.

I am eager to grow within a globally minded, mission-driven team and to contribute research that supports civic freedoms in a meaningful way. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my skills and perspective align with CIVICUS' current research priorities.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

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